

Microsoft Word

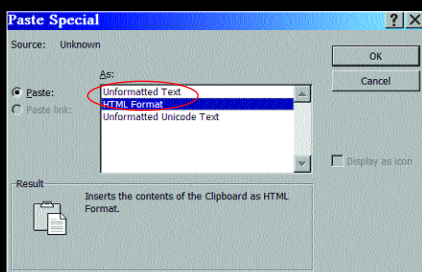
Word giving you trouble? Here are five common niggles, and what you can do about them

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1. When you paste text from a Web page, you get all unwanted formatting too

Reason: Word XP was designed so you could choose to either paste content as it is, or modify it to match the destination formatting, or keep only the text. Unfortunately, as it often happens, Word takes a long time to convert the Web page formatting to either plain text or to the destination formatting.

Solution: Use Paste Special. Go to the menu **Edit > Paste Special > As Unformatted Text**, and click OK. You can also use the



When copying and pasting text from Web pages, you often don't want the formatting

keyboard shortcut sequence, which is **[Alt] + [E] > [S] > [U] > [U] > [Enter]**.

2. Horizontal lines that you draw don't get deleted

Reason: When you draw a horizontal line using underscores, some of the lines get converted to double lines, and you find that deleting the lines and pressing [Enter] only results in more lines coming up. This happens because of the AutoFormat and Borders defaults in Word.

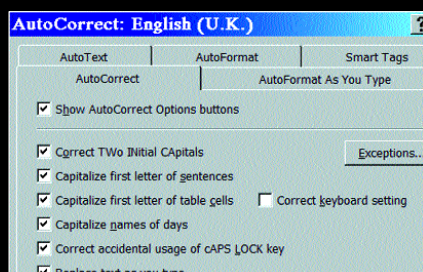
Solution: Once you have a document with some lines that you would like to remove, go to **Format > Borders and Shading > Borders** and click 'None'. Also go to **Tools > AutoCorrect Options > AutoFormat As You Type**, and under 'Apply as you type', uncheck 'Border lines'. At a later stage, you can enable the 'Border lines' and draw horizontal lines the way

you want. Remember, doing this will change the setting in the 'Borders and Shading' menu, so you will need to readjust that if you would like to remove the lines again.

3. Word keeps trying to help you

Reason: This, of course, is an inbuilt feature—Word was designed to help you as often as you might require it.

Solution: Go to **Tools > AutoCorrect Options**, and make changes under all five tabs. For instance, under 'AutoFormat', you can remove the automatic hyperlinking of Web addresses; under 'AutoFormat As You Type', you can remove the automatic generation of



Go to all five tabs in the AutoCorrect options to customise the way Word helps you

bulleted lists. Set everything the way you want it, so Word will help you as little or as much as you would like it to.

4. Word crashes or freezes as soon as it opens, or doesn't open at all

Reason: The odds are that your global template is corrupt, or something is loading automatically in your Word Startup folder that is wrongly configured.

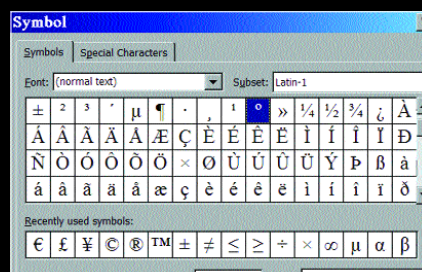
Solution: To check if it's a corrupt global template or some add-in that is loading on startup, go to **Start > Run** and key in "winword.exe /a" without the quotes. If Word launches fine, then it is mostly a bad normal.dot file or a corrupt add-in. To get yourself a new, uncorrupt template, simply close Word and search your computer for the 'normal.dot' file, and rename or delete it. If you find more

than one instance of normal.dot, rename or delete all of them. When you launch Word again, it will look for 'normal.dot', and if it cannot find it, Word will create a new one.

The usual location for 'normal.dot' is **<Drive Letter>:\Documents and Settings\<Your Username>\Application Data\Microsoft\Templates**

5. Inserting foreign characters is a pain

Reason: In order to insert a special or foreign character, you can either use the Insert menu or the Character Map. In case you feel wary of the thousands of signs that appear, there is an easier way to do it—using keyboard shortcuts.



For foreign characters you can either use 'insert symbol'—or keyboard shortcuts

Solution: Here are the keyboard shortcuts for various symbols:
à, è, ì, ò, ù, À, È, Ì, Ò, Ù: [Ctrl]+['] followed by the letter
á, é, í, ó, ú, Á, É, Í, Ó, Ú: [Ctrl]+['] followed by the letter
â, ê, î, ô, û, Â, Ê, Î, Ò, Ù: [Ctrl]+[Shift]+[^] followed by the letter
ã, ñ, õ, Ñ, Õ: [Ctrl]+[Shift]+[~] followed by the letter
ä, ë, ï, ö, ü, Ä, Ë, Ì, Ö, Ü: [Ctrl] + [Shift]+[.] followed by the letter
å, Å: [Ctrl]+[Shift]+[2] followed by a or A
æ, Æ: [Ctrl]+[Shift]+[7] followed by a or A
œ, Œ: [Ctrl]+[Shift]+[7] followed by o or O
ç, Ç: [Ctrl]+[.] followed by c or C
ø, Ø: [Ctrl]+[/] followed by o or O
¿: [Alt]+[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[?]
¡: [Alt]+[Ctrl]+[Shift]+[!]
ß: [Ctrl]+[Shift]+[&] followed by s ■

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